

WOODLAND DREAMS BASISBODY

LME BABY COLLECTION - WOODLAND DREAMS

A light, simple, unisex basisbody in stockinette stitch: round neck, short sleeves, no ribbing anywhere, only soft i-cord edges at the neck, sleeves and leg openings. A button shoulder opening on every size, and buttons at the crotch for easy nappy changes. Seven sizes, from 0-1 to 18-24 months. The basisbody is the foundation of the "Woodland Dreams" collection, designed to be combined with all six accessory patterns: lace collar, ruffle collar, Peter Pan collar, bib, i-cord suspenders and short vest.

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TIP: Read through the whole pattern and the size chart on page 4 before you start, and knit a 15 x 15 cm gauge swatch to check your tension, before casting on the body itself.

ABOUT THE WOODLAND DREAMS BASISBODY

THE FOUNDATION OF THE COLLECTION

The basisbody is the first piece in LME Woodland Dreams, a modular knitting collection in a Scandinavian, timeless style. The idea is simple: one well-fitting, light body, that can be built on with different collars, a bib, suspenders or a little vest, without knitting a new body for every outfit.

STYLE

Clean lines, soft transitions and calm natural colours: cream, linen, sand, oatmeal and beige. No ribbing anywhere, only stockinette stitch and a soft, rounded i-cord edge wherever the body opens: at the neck, sleeves and leg openings. As simple as possible, with no other fixed trim or decoration, the quiet foundation that the colour and shape of the accessories are allowed to lift.

A LIGHT, NAPPY-FRIENDLY FIT

Knitted with a little extra width over the chest and good body length, so there is room for a nappy without the body pulling tight. Short sleeves, not long, for a light and airy feel all year round. A button shoulder opening on every size makes the body quick to put on and take off, and a set of buttons at the crotch make nappy changes quick, without undressing the whole baby.

MATERIALS

YARN

Sandnes Garn Alpaka (100% alpaca), or an equivalent yarn with the same gauge. Choose one of the collection's calm natural colours for the body itself: cream, linen, sand, oatmeal or beige.

YARN REQUIREMENTS

Size	Yarn amount
0-1 mnd	85-95 g
1-3 mnd	100-110 g
3-6 mnd	110-125 g
6-9 mnd	130-145 g
9-12 mnd	150-165 g
12-18 mnd	170-190 g
18-24 mnd	195-215 g

NEEDLES AND NOTIONS

Circular needle 4 mm (40 cm and 60 cm), plus double-pointed needles or a short circular needle 4 mm for the short sleeves. Five small round wooden buttons: three for the crotch and two for the shoulder opening. Stitch markers (at least 4, ideally in four different colours for the four raglan lines), a tapestry needle, and a 3 mm crochet hook for crocheting the buttonhole loops.

SIZE CHART

Finished measurements, measured lying flat. Choose size by chest measurement, or one size up for extra room to grow.

Size	Chest width	Neck-to-crotch length	Sleeve length	Neck opening
0-1 mnd	46.4 cm	25 cm	4.0 cm	21 cm
1-3 mnd	49.1 cm	27 cm	4.5 cm	22 cm
3-6 mnd	51.8 cm	30 cm	5.0 cm	23 cm
6-9 mnd	54.5 cm	33 cm	5.5 cm	24 cm
9-12 mnd	57.3 cm	36 cm	6.0 cm	25 cm
12-18 mnd	60.0 cm	39 cm	6.5 cm	26 cm
18-24 mnd	62.7 cm	42 cm	7.0 cm	27 cm

The measurements are the finished chest width (full circumference), i.e. including the roomy fit the pattern is calculated with, not the baby's actual chest measurement. The sleeve length is measured from where the sleeve divides from the body (the shoulder line) to the cuff edge.

GAUGE AND DIFFICULTY LEVEL

GAUGE

22 stitches and 30 rounds in stockinette stitch = 10 x 10 cm, on 4 mm needles. This gauge is used in every calculation in the pattern. Always knit a swatch first: cast on 26 stitches, work stockinette stitch for approx. 12 cm, bind off and block lightly. If your gauge does not match, change to a smaller or larger needle until it does, not just to match the yarn.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

Medium. You should be comfortable knitting in the round, increasing and decreasing, picking up stitches, working simple buttonholes and an i-cord bind-off. No complicated stitch patterns, the whole body is stockinette stitch, only the edges are i-cord.

ABBREVIATIONS

Norwegian knitting terms with the English terms alongside.

Norwegian	English	Meaning
r	K	rett
vr	P	vrang
m	st(s)	maske(r)
o	rnd	omgang
øk	inc	øk (ta opp én tilleggsmaske)
felle	dec	felle (strikk to masker sammen)
r-felling	k2tog	strikk 2 r sammen (hellende høyre)
vr-felling	ssk	løft av, løft av, strikk sammen (hellende venstre)
ta opp m	pick up sts	ta opp masker langs en kant
fell av	BO	fell av / bind off
legg opp	CO	legg opp masker
i-cord	i-cord	strikket rørformet kant/snor, se side 8
rettpinne	straight needle	rett/enkeltpinne
rundpinne	circular needle	rundpinne
strømpepinne	DPN	strømpepinne (dobbeltpiss)
maskemarkør	st marker	maskemarkør

TIPS

- Use four stitch markers in different colours for the four raglan lines, it makes it much easier to keep track as you go.
- Always knit a swatch, even if you "usually" get this gauge, alpaca behaves a little differently from wool.
- Count your stitches at every checkpoint marked in the pattern. It is easier to fix a mistake 10 rounds back than 40.

HOW THE BODY IS CONSTRUCTED

The body is knitted top-down, in one piece, with short raglan sleeves. Five simple parts, in this order:

1. Neck opening and shoulder

Cast on flat at the neck with a small opening at the left shoulder, increase four raglan lines evenly until the yoke width is reached.

3. The body down to the crotch

Knit stockinette straight down, finish with an i-cord bind-off and a button opening at the crotch.

5. The neck edge

Finally: pick up stitches all the way around the neck opening and finish with the same i-cord bind-off as the rest of the body.

2. Divide for sleeves and body

Put the sleeve stitches on hold, cast on a few new stitches under each arm, continue in the round on the body alone.

4. The short sleeves

Put the sleeve stitches back on the needle, knit a few rounds down, finish with an i-cord bind-off.

THE I-CORD TECHNIQUE

The body has no ribbing anywhere. Instead, every open edge (leg opening, sleeve cuff, and finally the neck opening) is finished with the same soft i-cord bind-off. Learn the technique once here, it is used three times in the pattern.

Cast on 3 new stitches onto the left needle, right before the live stitches to be bound off. *Knit 2 of the 3 new stitches. Knit stitch 3 together with the next live stitch, through the back loop, and slip all 3 stitches back onto the left needle*. Repeat from * to * all the way around or along the edge, until every original, live stitch has been bound off. Finally, bind off the 3 remaining i-cord stitches as normal.

The result is a small, round, soft cord all along the edge, not a flat bind-off. Pull evenly, but not too tight, the i-cord edge should sit soft and rounded, not curl up.

PART 1: NECK OPENING AND SHOULDER

The body is cast on at the neck and knitted top-down. All seven sizes are cast on flat, with a small opening at the left shoulder that closes with two buttons, so the head passes through more easily, since the i-cord edge (unlike ribbing) does not stretch to speak of.

Example, 0-1 months: Cast on 46 stitches flat on a 4 mm circular needle (work back and forth, not in the round, for the first 4 rows, this becomes the shoulder opening). Place a stitch marker after stitch 20, after stitch 23, after stitch 43 and after stitch 46, these mark the four raglan lines (back-left sleeve, left sleeve-front, front-right sleeve, right sleeve-back).

Knit stockinette back and forth for 4 rows (this is the shoulder opening). Then join to knit in the round (place a marker for the start of the round), and continue straight on to the raglan increases on the next page. The neck edge itself is not finished here, it is finished with i-cord at the very end, see part 5.

THE SHOULDER OPENING, FINISHING

Once the whole body is finished (see finishing on page 15): edge both sides of the shoulder opening with 1 round of neat edge stitches, or let the i-cord edge from the neck finish run all the way out into the opening. Crochet two small loops (buttonholes) on the front edge with a 3 mm crochet hook, and sew two wooden buttons onto the back edge, directly opposite the loops.

PART 2: RAGLAN INCREASES

Now increase evenly along all four raglan lines, until the yoke width is reached. The number of increase rounds is the same for all seven sizes here, it is the neck cast-on that makes the size difference, see the grading table below.

Increase round (every 2nd round): increase 1 stitch right before and 1 stitch right after each of the four raglan markers (8 stitches increased in total per increase round). Knit plain, with no increases, on the round in between.

Size	Neck cast-on	Increase rounds	Rounds to yoke depth	Sts at yoke depth
0-1 mnd	46	7	14	102
1-3 mnd	52	7	14	108
3-6 mnd	58	7	14	114
6-9 mnd	64	7	14	120
9-12 mnd	70	7	14	126
12-18 mnd	76	7	14	132
18-24 mnd	82	7	14	138

Check: count your stitches. They should match the number in the "Sts at yoke depth" column for your size, before you move on to part 3.

PART 3: DIVIDE FOR SLEEVES AND BODY

Now the yoke is divided into two sleeves and a body. Do this the same way for every size, use your own row's stitch numbers from the table on the previous page.

Example with numbers for 0-1 months, use your own numbers from the table on the previous page.

- Knit across the 34 front stitches (stitches between the left and right raglan markers, front section).
- Put the next 17 stitches (left sleeve) on a holder or spare needle, to rest.
- Cast on 2 new stitches right over the sleeve gap, these give a little extra ease under the arm.
- Knit across the 34 back stitches.
- Put the next 17 stitches (right sleeve) on a holder or spare needle, to rest.
- Cast on 2 new stitches over the other sleeve gap.
- You now have 72 stitches on the needle, in the round, the body alone. Place a marker for the start of the round at centre back.

PART 4: THE BODY DOWN TO THE CROTCH

Knit stockinette stitch straight down, in the round, with no increasing or decreasing, until the body reaches the desired length. See the table below for how many rounds to work for your size.

Size	Body stitches	Rounds stockinette	Finished length
0-1 mnd	72	61	25 cm
1-3 mnd	76	67	27 cm
3-6 mnd	80	76	30 cm
6-9 mnd	84	85	33 cm
9-12 mnd	88	94	36 cm
12-18 mnd	92	103	39 cm
18-24 mnd	96	112	42 cm

Once the body has the desired length: knit back and forth (not in the round) for 4-5 cm at centre front, right over where the placket should be (see buttons at the crotch below), to create the opening. Bind off all stitches all the way around the leg opening with an i-cord bind-off, as described on page 8.

BUTTONS AT THE CROTCH

Edge both sides of the 4-5 cm long placket at centre front with 2 rounds of garter stitch. Then crochet three small loops (buttonholes) on one side with a 3 mm crochet hook, and sew three wooden buttons onto the other side, directly opposite the loops. The placket makes nappy changes quick without undressing the baby.

PART 5: THE SHORT SLEEVES

Put the sleeve stitches back onto the needle from the holder, one sleeve at a time. Also pick up the 2 stitches that were cast on under the arm in part 3, so you knit in the round in one piece. The sleeves are short, just a few rounds down from the yoke.

Size	Sts per sleeve	Rounds stockinette	Finished sleeve length
0-1 mnd	19	12	4.0 cm
1-3 mnd	20	14	4.5 cm
3-6 mnd	21	15	5.0 cm
6-9 mnd	22	16	5.5 cm
9-12 mnd	23	18	6.0 cm
12-18 mnd	24	20	6.5 cm
18-24 mnd	25	21	7.0 cm

Bind off all stitches with an i-cord bind-off, as described on page 8. Repeat the same way for the other sleeve.

THE NECK EDGE, THE FINAL STEP

Finally, once the rest of the body is finished and assembled (see finishing on the next page): pick up 1 stitch in each stitch all the way around the neck cast-on edge, including along both edges of the shoulder opening, with a 4 mm circular needle.

Knit 1 round of plain stockinette, with no increasing or decreasing. Then bind off all stitches with an i-cord bind-off, as described on page 8. This gives the neck the same soft, rounded edge as the leg opening and the sleeves.

FINISHING

- 1 Sew together the 2 stitches that were cast on under each arm, with a small, neat seam, so no hole is left.
- 2 Weave in all loose ends securely on the wrong side, and trim them short.
- 3 Pick up stitches and knit the i-cord edge around the neck, as described on page 14.
- 4 Sew on the buttons at the crotch (part 4) and at the shoulder (part 1), and crochet the buttonhole loops if you did not do so along the way.
- 5 Lightly steam-block the body on the wrong side, avoid pressing directly on the i-cord edges, they should keep their rounded shape.
- 6 Finally, check that every button is securely attached, and that no loose threads or stitches can come undone.

SAFETY AND CARE

SAFETY

- Always use small, securely attached buttons, and sew them on with double thread, several times through each hole.
- Check the buttons regularly, especially after washing, and reattach them at the first sign of looseness.
- This pattern is not intended for children who put small objects in their mouth unsupervised, never leave a baby alone and unsupervised in the body during the first while of wearing it.
- All measurements and stitch counts in this pattern are calculated for a roomy, comfortable fit, not a tight safety fit, always follow current safety recommendations for children's clothing.

CARE INSTRUCTIONS

Hand wash gently in lukewarm water with wool wash, or machine wash on a wool cycle at 30 degrees. Press out the water, ease into shape, and dry lying flat on a towel. Avoid hanging the body up to dry, alpaca can stretch out of shape.

ALL DONE!

Congratulations, your basisbody is finished! It is made to be the foundation of the whole "Woodland Dreams" collection, ready to be combined with the collars, the bib, the suspenders or the vest.

THE REST OF THE COLLECTION

- Lace collar, a loose collar that fastens at the back.
- Ruffle collar, the same fastening, a little more romantic.
- Peter Pan collar, a classic rounded collar.
- Bib, tied with an i-cord or a button.
- I-cord suspenders, the collection's signature piece, adjustable and crossing at the back.
- Short vest, with wooden buttons at the front, worn over the body.
- Woodland Fluffy Skirt, a crocheted skirt made to match the body.

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